# HOORVIA - ILLUSTRATOR PATHFINDER CHART: PRINTABLE SHAPE OPERATIONS GUIDE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

**Tech & Software · Sheet #1**

| Operation | Group | What It Does | Best For |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Unite** | Shape Mode | Merges overlapping shapes into one, keeps the front object's fill | Welding logos and icons |
| **Minus Front** | Shape Mode | Cuts the front shape out of the back shape | Punching holes, stencil cuts |
| **Intersect** | Shape Mode | Keeps only the area where all shapes overlap | Crescent moons, lens shapes |
| **Exclude** | Shape Mode | Keeps everything except the overlapping area | Rings, hollow shapes |
| **Divide** | Pathfinder | Splits shapes along every overlap into separate pieces | Breaking art into color blocks |
| **Trim** | Pathfinder | Removes hidden parts behind front shapes, strips strokes | Cleaning up layered art |
| **Merge** | Pathfinder | Joins same-fill shapes, trims hidden parts of the rest | Flattening same-color art |
| **Crop** | Pathfinder | Keeps only the back shape's area inside the front shape | Cropping art to a frame |
| **Outline** | Pathfinder | Turns every edge into stroked outlines, removes fills | Line-art conversions |
| **Minus Back** | Pathfinder | Cuts the back shape out of the front shape | Reverse stencil cuts |
| **Expand (Alt+click)** | Shape Mode | Alt+click any Shape Mode to expand it at once | Making results editable paths |
| **Open the panel** | Shortcut | Window > Pathfinder, or Shift+Ctrl+F9 (Win) / Shift+Cmd+F9 (Mac) | Fast access while drawing |

**PRO TIP:** Mind the stacking order: Minus Front and Minus Back read top-to-bottom - check which shape is in front first.